

1839. Netherlands' first railways connected the cities of Amsterdam and Haarlem that same year. In Britain, Queen Victoria took her first train journey, travelling on the Great Western Railway on her way to Windsor in 1842. The railways reached Basel in Switzerland, via France in 1844 and Switzerland's first domestic line opened in 1847. India, too, marked its presence on the world railway map, with the inauguration of the first passenger train to run from Bombay to Thana in 1853 (see [The Curious Case of the First Train](#)).

In the US, the most significant moment took place on 10 May 1869 after a ceremonial golden spike was hammered into a dusty part of Utah at Promontory. As the locomotives *Jupiter* and UP No. 119 were pulled up towards each other, it marked the completion of the first transcontinental railway and a key moment in the development of the US. The railways era had truly begun.